

RAM MANDIR

THE NEW HINDU PUSH

A century-long acrimonious dispute over the Ram Janmabhoomi gets resolved in courts in favour of the majority community, paving the way for the realisation of the Hindutva dream of a Ram temple in Ayodhya

IT had to be now or never. There was a BJP government at the Centre, and in the state of Uttar Pradesh. It then took just 41 days for a five-judge bench to bring the curtains down on a dispute that had simmered on for more than a century.

At the centre of that dispute lay 2.77 acres of land, which many Hindus believe to be the birthplace of Ram. The trespass by the first Mughal emperor Babur had long been avenged, when the mosque his commander Mir Baqi had erected, the Babri Masjid, was brought down by a frenzied mob in the wake of L.K. Advani's rath yatra in the '90s. Much blood was shed in